By defining this operational rule in policy instead of code, engineering avoided the need to change deployment scripts or add separate checkpoints in each tool. The policy engine enforced the rule consistently across all production environments, ensuring uniform behavior without adding operational complexity. This is exactly the kind of cross-system requirement that shared operational policies are meant to address.

15.3.3 Application policies

Application policies represent the most specific and narrowest layer. These policies determine how an individual service operates: which resources can be accessed, what actions are permitted, and who has the authority to carry them out. They are managed by the product or engineering teams responsible for the specific product or service.

Because application policies restrict authorization scope to a specific domain, they often specify particular resource types, roles, or allowed actions. For example, ACME's finance reporting system uses a policy like this:

```
permit(
    principal in Group::"Finance",
    action == Report::"view",
    resource in Report::"internal_financials"
);
```

This policy describes the business logic of the finance reporting service. It does not aim to enforce device posture, authentication freshness, or time-based limits, since foundational and shared operational layers already manage these.

When the finance reporting team began defining its access rules in policy, this division of responsibility proved helpful. The operations team responsible for the finance system could focus on accurate domain rules without worrying about organization-wide controls. Meanwhile, Sam's team continued to specify the security guarantees ACME required everywhere.